

which have replaced many of the dialog boxes that were a common feature in Office 97 and Office 2000. Office 2003 has also added new task panes such as the Research task pane.

A task pane is a multipurpose window pane that appears on the right side of the window of an Office application. The list that follows describes the global task panes that you will find in all the Office applications.

- m **New File Task Pane:** Enables you to start a new file in a particular application (for example, in Word, it is called the 'New Document' task pane; in Excel, it is called the 'New Workbook' task pane). It also provides access to various document templates and the capability to open recently used files.
- m **Office Clipboard Task Pane:** Enables you to view items that you copy and cut to the Office Clipboard. You can manage up to 24 items on the Clipboard and paste them in any application within Office.
- m **Clip Art Task Pane:** Enables you to search the Office Clip Gallery and insert clip art into your Office application documents.
- m **Search Task Pane:** Enables you to search for files from any of the Office applications.
- m **Research Task Pane:** This allows you to take advantage of a number of research and reference services. A number of these references are accessed via online services such as Microsoft Encarta.

Task panes also house features that handle specific purposes in each of the Office applications. For example, in PowerPoint, the 'Slide Layout' task pane is used to select a design format for a new or existing PowerPoint presentation slide.

When you are working in an Office application, such as Word or Excel, you can open a task pane and switch between the different task pane features offered in that particular application. To open a